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# INDIA'S GREAT POWER POLITICS

## A framework for analysis

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Managing the rise of China is India's foremost foreign policy challenge. In this volume, we seek to understand whether India's policy on China is characterised by balance-of-power politics or by engagement through economic, institutional, and diplomatic cooperation and to what extent it combines these approaches. We examine if New Delhi is balancing or accommodating China, or if it is hedging between these two policy options, and in which of these directions India's policy is moving. Moreover, we elaborate on the main risks and challenges India is facing with regard to these various policy approaches. Finally, India's evolving policy on China sheds light on important aspects of balance-of-power theory and hedging. Before we engage with these questions, we need to take into account five major developments over the last five to ten years that change the role and position of India in Asian security.

First, India is emerging as a great power facilitated by impressive economic growth over the last decade.[1] India's economy has outrun that of its neighbours and, since